

“It’ll Blow Your Mind Away” Marketing Correction & Redemption

**Burger King
Grace, Kelsi, Izzy**

What is the Advertisement?



IT JUST TASTES BETTER 

IT'LL BLOW YOUR MIND AWAY

BK SUPER SEVEN INCHER

  **\$6.25 MEAL**

Fill your desire for something long, juicy and flame-grilled with the **NEW BK SUPER SEVEN INCHER**. Yearn for more after you taste the mind-blowing burger that comes with a single beef patty, topped with American cheese, crispy onions and the A.1.[®] Thick & Hearty Steak Sauce.

This advertisement from our company, *Burger King*®, shows a woman with her mouth open in front of a **BK SUPER SEVEN INCHER**.

Its main selling phrase is, “**It’ll Blow your Mind Away**”. It also states in the bottom right corner, “**Fill your desire for something long, juicy, and flame-grilled.**”



Our teams approach:

Burger King® press believed the ad would generate **shock value** by using an image and slogan that would be hard to ignore in order to maximize attention from consumers so they would buy the product.

The ad used other tactics to grab attention such as **emotional & sex appeal**, as well as, emphasizing the cost of the meal. The marketing team thought the slogan “It’ll Blow Your Mind Away” would target the audiences emotions like **humor** or **surprise** so they would be more likely to remember the ad and therefore, purchase the food. As for the **emphasis on cost**, our team wanted to ensure consumers were aware of the cheap cost so that they would eat at *Burger King*® instead of other food establishments.



What's wrong the Advertisement?



Offensive Content: The ad uses sexual innuendo by featuring a “seven-inch” burger and a woman with her mouth open, alluding to oral sex. This approach, based on the idea that “Sex Sells,” has been perceived as aggressive and offensive.

Negative Brand Perception: The attention gained was negative, as the company is now being labeled as misogynistic and discriminatory due to the ad's content.

Financial Impact: Instead of profiting, the campaign put the company at a loss, indicating a poor return on investment.

Ethical and Legal Concerns: The company used a model's photo without her knowledge and did not compensate her, only paying for stock images. This raises ethical and possible legal issues.



Ethical Dilemmas:

Burger King® recognizes the ethical dilemmas we had previously disregarded.



Personal

- Burger King should not allow an offensive advertisement to be released, as a company that supports all its consumers.
- Burger King® promotes creating a positive and inclusive experience for consumers, but an advertisement that sexualizes a woman without her consent directly contradicts those stated values.

Social

- It is not socially responsible to use someone's photo without their consent; the model's rights to privacy and personal agency were violated.
- This advertisement harmed her reputation.
- Reinforced harmful gender stereotypes.
- Women make up more than half of the global population, and alienating such a large part of society causes not only social but economic harm.

Correction to Advertisement:

Leave sexual innuendos out of food publicity: Instead of our ad slogan being “It’ll Blow Your Mind Away,” we will shift our focus to the customization aspect we offer when consuming our food. The new catchphrase will say “Have It Your Way, Burger or Sandwich for only \$6.25 Today”

Create new imagery: We will remove the photo of the model we used without consent, and instead display a sandwich and a burger shifting the focus to be solely on the food we are advertising.

Re-word size description: Our intention is to advertise the amount of food you get for the amount you pay. Instead of describing the size of the product as “super seven incher” or “fill your desire for something long, juicy, and flame grilled...” we will simply emphasis “for only \$6.25 today.”

We will keep displaying the price for the meal “\$6.25”



Redemption:

- **Public apology:** a Formal public apology has been released acknowledging the harm and taking full responsibility, emphasising our value of all consumers.
- **Compensation for model.** The model, who is asking to remain anonymous will be compensated \$250,000 which includes full payment for the unauthorized image use as well as any emotional distress this may have caused.
- **Removal of Advertisement.** The advertisement has been removed and will not be promoted in an inappropriate way again.
- **Strength within our consent policies.** We are implementing updated consent policies effective immediately, requiring documented written approval from all individuals featured in marketing materials, along with mandatory ethics and representation training for marketing staff.
- **Support women's organizations.** Lastly we will be committing \$5 million in donations to women's shelters and advocacy programs around the united states.



Mindset going forward:

We acknowledge our mistake of allowing this advertisement be released. Moving forward we will be more thoughtful and intentional with the development of Burger Kings® advertisements. In addition we will hold our marketing team and internal franchise members to higher ethical standards. In addition, all future advertisements will be reviewed to ensure they are appropriate, respectful, and aligned with our values of dignity and equality for all individuals.

With any further questions or concerns you can contact our press team manager, Billy Kingsley at (603)736-4927 or email at BKpress@bkingHG.com

